

Professional Practices - Questionnaire

Interview Questions:

The questions are cross departmental including Introduction & Data Governance, AI, Predictive Analytics, and Algorithmic Fairness, Data Security, Transparency, and Consent, Corporate IT Culture & Whistleblowing, and The Future of Healthcare IT Ethics.

1. **Patient-Centric Responsibility:** As a platform managing millions of patient records across various healthcare systems, how does Persivia define its core ethical responsibility toward the individual patient whose data it aggregates and processes?
2. **Data Aggregation & Privacy:** Persivia integrates clinical and claims data from dozens of disparate EHR systems. What are the standard engineering and compliance protocols used to ensure data anonymization, security, and the principle of least privilege during this aggregation?
3. **Balancing Value & Care:** In the context of value-based care models, how do your teams balance the business logic of reducing healthcare costs with the ethical obligation to ensure algorithms don't inadvertently discourage necessary, comprehensive patient care?
4. **Mitigating Algorithmic Bias:** Persivia utilizes predictive models to flag high-risk patients. What specific steps do your data science teams take during the training and validation phases to identify and eliminate demographic, racial, or socio-economic biases in these models?
5. **AI Explainability:** When your AI models recommend a specific clinical pathway or risk adjustment inside the CareTrak® tool, how do you ensure "explainability" so that healthcare providers understand the why behind the AI's output?
6. **Error Correction Protocols:** If a deployed predictive model is found to disproportionately flag or miss certain populations inaccurately, what is the engineering protocol for pulling back, auditing, and correcting that model?
7. **Human-in-the-Loop:** How does Persivia technically and philosophically ensure that there is a "human in the loop," ensuring AI recommendations augment rather than override a physician's clinical judgment?
8. **Client Transparency:** Given the sensitive nature of your Health Data Platform, what ethical guidelines govern how transparent you are with clients (hospitals, ACOs) regarding the limitations, error rates, or data storage mechanisms of your systems?
9. **Incident Response Ethics:** In the event of a system vulnerability or potential data exposure, what is Persivia's ethical framework for incident response? How do you weigh legal compliance against the ethical obligation of immediate transparency?
10. **Data Ownership & Opt-Outs:** How do your database architectures handle patient consent ethically? If a patient opts out of data sharing at the hospital level, how is that cascading withdrawal handled, especially if their data has already informed machine learning models?

11. **Internal Reporting Channels:** If a software engineer at Persivia notices a potential ethical flaw in how patient data is being routed or a security loophole in the code, what internal channels exist for them to raise these concerns without fear of retaliation?
12. **Adapting to AI Regulations:** As federal regulations around AI in healthcare continuously evolve, how does Persivia proactively adapt its software engineering practices to stay ahead of both legal mandates and ethical standards?
13. **Cross Functional Team:** How does your team communicate as there's a division; some are working in Pakistan and others abroad.
14. **Agile vs. Mission-Critical Testing:** When rolling out rapid updates to the CareSpace® platform, how do your development teams balance the pressure of agile release cycles with the rigorous quality assurance required for mission-critical healthcare software?
15. **Emerging Challenges:** From your perspective working inside Persivia, what is the single biggest emerging ethical challenge for IT professionals in population health management today, and how is the company preparing for it?